Ritika Shrestha

shrest_r2@denison.edu | (740) 328-9521 | LinkedIn | GitHub | Portfolio | 8709 49th Ave, College Park, MD, 20740

EDUCATION

Denison University Granville, OH

B.S. in Computer Science and Mathematics, GPA: 3.79/4.00 May 2026

- *Coursework*: Data Structures, Algorithm Design and Analysis, Database Systems; *Awards*: Dean's List

Cornell Tech May 2025 – May 2026

Breakthrough Tech **AI/ML**, Fellow

EXPERIENCE

Freelance AI Automation Developer **ZCurtains** Sep 2026 – Present

- Replaced a small business's manual lead intake with an AI workflow connecting **5** tools (Jotform, Make, Airtable, OneDrive, Claude API) through webhooks, owning it from requirements to go-live
- Used the **Claude API** to extract structured fields from free-text forms against a JSON schema, then ran **4** rules before an AI agent picked from **9** next actions, with a person approving any customer email
- Wrote a **Python** test harness on **25+** payloads, including prompt-injection cases, that caught **4** bugs that looked like success, and handed off with an activity log, user guide, and docs

AI Fellow **Handshake AI** Apr 2026 – Aug 2026

- Shipped coding projects end to end with **AI coding agents** (Claude Code, Codex), owning a 5-phase GitHub workflow that scoped each task, defined expected behavior, and benchmarked **4** frontier models
- Wrote evaluation rubrics that turned vague requirements into checkable criteria, then reviewed model-generated code against them to find where AI coding tools succeed or fail

Junior Software Engineer **Denison IT Web Services** Nov 2022 – May 2026

- Rebuilt site search on the university's production site with a JSON endpoint and async TypeScript components, replacing heavy SQL queries and full-page reloads; engagement rose **25%**
- Resolved live issues and support tickets for **4** years, automated deploys in GitLab CI/CD, and migrated a database schema in place with a Drupal (PHP) hook without losing data

Software Engineering Intern **TransCore** Jun 2025 – Aug 2025

- Built a **RAG** chatbot that automated FAQ and toll-processing inquiries, with semantic search over company documents in Redis and a Python (FastAPI) API serving self-hosted LLMs on Google Cloud
- Added guardrails against prompt injection, routed billing issues to human agents, and scored replies with an LLM judge on a **1–5** rubric, with manual checks for hallucination

Software Engineering Intern **Real AI Dynamics (RAID)** Dec 2024 – May 2025

- Built a recommendation service live across **10** micro-SaaS products from user click, view, and purchase data, and taught AI workshops as an instructor on how the models learn

PROJECTS

Little AI Helper — AI agent on the Chrome Web Store Apr 2026 – Present

- Built a Chrome extension that automates job applications, reading form fields and filling them with tailored answers from Gemini structured output, and review pull requests from **36** contributors
- Kept API keys server-side with a Cloud Run proxy to Vertex AI and a **50** requests/day per-user cap to control cost

Open Source Contributions — AI agent and LLM developer tooling

- Opened **20+** merged and in-review pull requests in AI agent tools totaling **300k+** GitHub stars, including tool-call recovery in crewAI, SSE streaming fixes in llama_index, and provider guards in litellm
- Traced silent failures to root cause, fixing lost memories on JSON-in-prose output in mem0, and revised each pull request based on maintainer review feedback

SKILLS

- **AI & Automation:** Claude API, Gemini / Vertex AI, RAG, LLM evaluation, prompt engineering, AI agents, structured output, Make, Airtable, Jotform, webhooks, REST APIs
- **Languages & Tools:** Python, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, C#, FastAPI, React, Node.js, .NET 8, PostgreSQL, Redis, Docker, Git, GitHub Actions, Claude Code, Codex, GitHub Copilot
- **Leadership:** Teaching Assistant for Mathematical Foundations of CS (**30%** grade improvement)